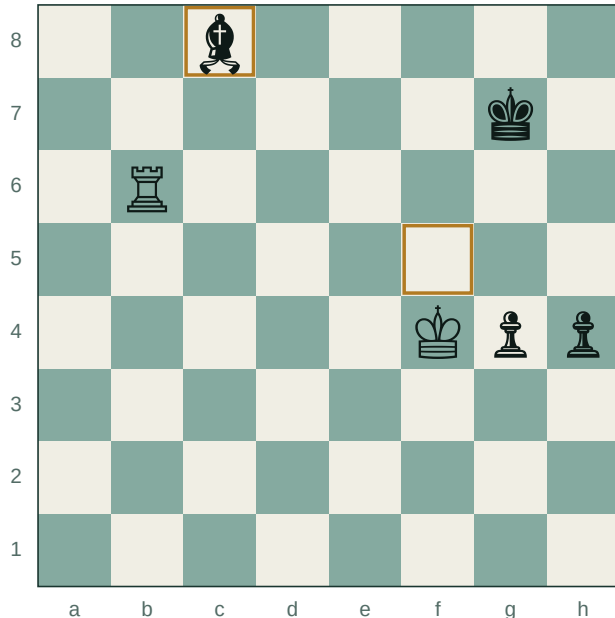


Exposed-king tactics: White, move 63

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 62...Bc8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

63. Rc6 Bb7 64. Rc7+ Kf6 65. Rxb7

63.Rc6 The rook moves from b6 to c6. Recorded reply: **63...Bb7**.

64.Rc7+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From c7 it attacks king on g7 and bishop on b7. Recorded reply: **64...Kf6**.

65.Rxb7 The rook captures the bishop on b7.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 2 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on g7. Geometrically undefended: bishop on c8. Check for tactical protection.